

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

What an uncanny story!



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about coincidences, strange events, and superstitions.
- I can talk about possibility and certainty.
- I can talk about life experiences.

Ask your partner:

- Do you know any unbelievable stories of survival? What happened?
- Do you believe in miracles? Why or why not?

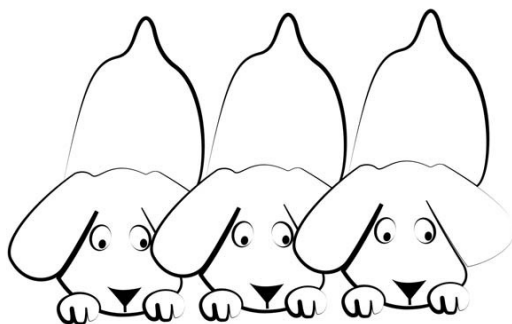




Let's Explore!

Let's read an amazing story about Lily. **How is she doing*** now?

* You can use this question to ask how someone is.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

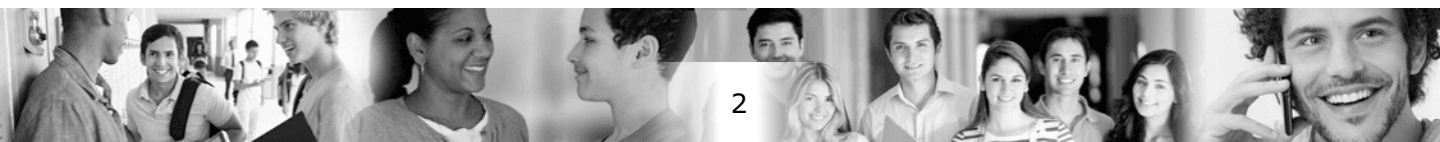
Child Is Saved by Puppies

This might be the most uncanny, but most heartwarming story of the year so far. It's the kind of story that leaves you baffled and perplexed - but in a good way! A five-year-old girl was found safe and sound 12 hours after she had disappeared from her home in St. Simon. She was saved from freezing to death by snuggling with three puppies until she was found the next day.

Lily Jackson had wandered away from her home on Friday afternoon. She was looking for her puppy who had run into a field near her house. She had worn light clothing and did not have gloves or a hat with her. When her mother found her on Saturday afternoon, Lily was curled up with Muffy, Ruffles, and Pluto, three of her four puppies.

Lily's mother, Sarah, is convinced that her daughter would have frozen if it hadn't been for the puppies who stayed with her all through the night and kept her warm. Now Lily is doing well, with only a few scratches on her face. But it could have been a real tragedy and it must have been very scary.

Lily decided she may become a vet when she gets older to honor those extraordinary animals that saved her life.





Let's Practice!

Can you imagine how little Lily felt while being lost?

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. so / most / Lily's / the / year / might / the / far. / of / story / story / be / uncanny

2. thinks / her / frozen / if / . / daughter / mother / kept / who / hadn't / puppies / the / for / have / would / it / her / been / warm / Lily's

3. awful / could / . / been / really / a / have / It / tragedy

4. been / have / for / scary / very / It / Lily / . / must

5. become / when / experience / Thanks / a / she / , / vet / this / believes / gets / she / older. / may / Lily / to



Let's Practice!

Don't let the misspelled* words confuse you!

*spelled incorrectly.

Instructions: Proofread the sentence. Identify and cross out the incorrect words. Write the correct words in the given space. Use capital letters where necessary.

1. Lily's mother most have felt terrified when she noticed her daughter had gonne missing.

2. It if weren't for the puppies, Lily's incanny story coud have been totally difference.

3. As a people who has only heard the story, I truly feel bafled and perplex. _____





Let's Practice!

4. The fiald next to Lily's house might be scarie for her now that she's back home.

5. Snuggling with animals might sound estrange, but helped prevent a trajedy.





Extension Activity

Read and tell a story about an animal that saved someone.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Tell a partner about an animal story like the one in the dialogue.
- Go online and find a story (in English) about an animal saving a human.
- Read the story and write down some of the key events.
- Retell the story using your notes and past tenses.
- Talk about what might/could have happened if the animal had not been there

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I talk about life experiences.

☐ ☐

I read about life experiences.

☐ ☐

I write notes on life experiences.

☐ ☐

I use the notes to talk about life experiences.

☐ ☐

I talk about possibility and certainty.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- baffled** (adjective): confused; unable to understand or explain something
e.g. It's the kind of story that leaves you baffled and perplexed.
- to curl up** (verb): to sit or lie down with your legs and arms bent close to your body
e.g. Lily was curled up with Muffy, Ruffles, and Pluto, three of her four puppies.
- extraordinary** (adjective): beyond what is usual; exceptional and surprising
e.g. Those extraordinary animals saved her life.
- field** (noun): a piece of open land in the country
e.g. She was looking for her puppy who had run into a field near her house.
- to honor** (verb): to show special respect and recognition
e.g. Lily became a vet to honor the animals that saved her life.
- light clothing** (noun): clothes that are not heavy; comfortable clothing
e.g. Light clothing is appropriate for spring.
- perplexed** (adjective): confused and worried
e.g. The girl's story left me baffled and perplexed.
- to snuggle** (verb): to lie close to another being looking for warmth or affection
e.g. She was saved from freezing to death by snuggling with three puppies.
- uncanny** (adjective): mysterious; strange and difficult to describe
e.g. It was really uncanny to hear the dog had survived the catastrophe.
- to wander** (verb): to walk around an area with no specific destination
e.g. Lily Jackson had wandered away from her home on Friday afternoon.



Learning Points

Modals for Possibility and Certainty

You use modal verbs to add meaning to other verbs. They come before the dictionary form (Infinitive without 'to') of the main verb.

Modal verbs can add meaning connected with certainty or possibility. Some common modals are: *might*, *may*, *could*, *would*, and *must*.

Might, *May*, *Could* and *Would* are used to talk about possibility. *Might* is less certain than *May*.

May, *Could* and *Would* have similar degrees of possibility.

Must is used to talk about certainty (something is 100% certain). The short form of *must* not is *mustn't*.

You can use modals with a variety of verb tenses. You can use them to talk about possible or certain actions in the present, past or future.

You can use modals with the Simple Present tense:

*This **might be** the most uncanny, but most heartwarming story of the year so far.*

(Here, the modal *might* adds the meaning of **possibility**:

It is possible that this is the most uncanny story of the year.)

You can use modals with have+past participle to talk about the possibility of a past event that is not clear in the present context:

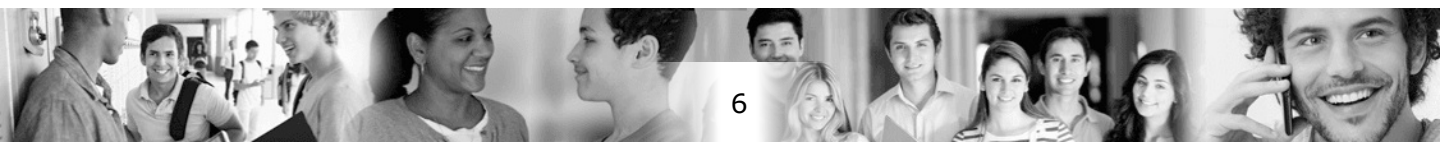
*It **could have been** a real tragedy.*

(Here, the modal *could* adds the meaning of **possibility**:

It is possible that it was a real tragedy.)

Examples:

- *Lily's mother, Sarah, is convinced that her daughter would have frozen if it hadn't been for the puppies who stayed with her all through the night and kept her warm.*
- *Lily decided she may be a vet when she gets older to honor those extraordinary animals that saved her life.*





Learning Points

The Past Perfect and Simple Past Tenses

You use the **Past Perfect** tense to identify and talk about an 'earlier past'.

You use the **Past Continuous** tense to talk about an action that was happening at a time before now.

You use the **Simple Past** to talk about a finished action that happened at a specific time in the past.

When you are talking about a past event, you can refer to something that happened at an earlier time to that past event by using the **Past Perfect** tense.

The structure of the **Past Perfect** is:

Subject + had + past participle

*When I arrived at the party, Vanessa **had** already **gone** home.*

Which event happened first? Vanessa went home.

Which event happened later? I arrived at the party.

You use the **Past Perfect** tense (not **Simple Past**) when you want to talk about how long something had continued **up to a past moment**.

*Until recently, detectives **had used** a limited number of tools to help them solve crimes.*

Detectives used a limited number of tools from the past until recently.

Examples:

- *A five-year-old girl was found safe and sound 12 hours after she had disappeared from her home in St. Simon.*
- *Lily Jackson had wandered away from her home on Friday afternoon.*
- *She had worn light clothing and did not have gloves or a hat with her.*

